

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

RESPIRATORY PROTECTION

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Control airborne hazards at source and, when a respirator is required, verify the correct device and cartridge, medical clearance, fit testing and user seal check.

KEY HAZARDS

1



DUST

2



FUME

3



VAPOUR

4



GAS

5



OXYGEN DEFICIENCY

6



WRONG CARTRIDGE

7



POOR FIT

8



FACIAL HAIR

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

100%

Medical clearance and task match

Annual

Fit test for tight-fitting respirators

Every use

User seal check



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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# RESPIRATORY PROTECTION

## STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA 1910.134 requires a written program integrating hazard evaluation, medical evaluation, fit testing, training and maintenance.

### OSHA 1910.134(c)

#### WRITTEN PROGRAM

Document task-specific selection, use, maintenance and program-administrator responsibilities.

### OSHA 1910.134(e)

#### MEDICAL EVALUATION

Confirm medical ability to wear the respirator before fit testing or use.

### OSHA 1910.134(f)

#### FIT TESTING

Fit test the same make, model, style and size before initial use and at least annually.

### OSHA 1910.134(k)

#### TRAINING

Train limitations, donning, doffing, seal checks, signs of failure and maintenance in practice.

## MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- |                                                           |                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Exposure assessment / monitoring | <input type="checkbox"/> Written respiratory program     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Medical-clearance record         | <input type="checkbox"/> Fit-test record                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Cartridge-change schedule        | <input type="checkbox"/> Training and maintenance record |

## SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- What is the contaminant and concentration?
- Why is this cartridge suitable?
- How is the seal check performed?

## FIT, CARTRIDGE AND SEAL CHECK



Medical clearance - Fit test - Correct cartridge - Clean-shaven seal - Seal check

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## CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

### 1. ELIMINATE THE SOURCE

Choose a less hazardous material or method; never assume exposure without assessment.

### 2. VENTILATE AND ISOLATE

Use local exhaust and enclosure; select equipment for contaminant type and concentration.

### 3. SELECT THE CORRECT RESPIRATOR

Verify medical clearance and fit test; keep facial hair out of the sealing surface.

### 4. FIT, CHECK AND MAINTAIN

Perform a seal check every use; follow cartridge change, cleaning and dry-storage schedules.

### CRITICAL WARNING



**Never use an air-purifying respirator in an unknown, oxygen-deficient or IDLH atmosphere. Stop and plan an appropriate supplied-air system.**

## SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- |                                                      |                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Exposure assessed           | <input type="checkbox"/> Source control installed  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Respirator task-suitable    | <input type="checkbox"/> Medical clearance current |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Fit test current            | <input type="checkbox"/> Facial hair clear         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Cartridge correct / current | <input type="checkbox"/> Seal check passed         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Clean storage ready         |                                                    |

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RESPIRATORY PROTECTION

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site:

Date:

Presented by:

Work area:

| No | Full Name | Company / Role | Signature |
|----|-----------|----------------|-----------|
| 1  |           |                |           |
| 2  |           |                |           |
| 3  |           |                |           |
| 4  |           |                |           |
| 5  |           |                |           |
| 6  |           |                |           |
| 7  |           |                |           |
| 8  |           |                |           |
| 9  |           |                |           |
| 10 |           |                |           |
| 11 |           |                |           |
| 12 |           |                |           |